VIA TURKEY

- Agents obtain a UK visa on a work permit, basis which the traveller enters Turkey with an e-visa and lives there for 90 days
- In this period, they fly into a safe Central American country, where they stay for a week to a year
- At an opportune time, the agents move them into the US

Cost: ₹80-90 lakh



VIA CANADA

- Agents acquire a valid visa for Canada on forged university admission or work permit
- The donkey stays in cold border areas of Canada for a few months
- At an opportune time, the agent sends them across the border—barely a kilometre walk

Cost: ₹80 lakh

CULTURAL/TOURISM

- Agents take the travellers to Dubai with a valid visa
- From there, a charter plane flies them to Central American or European Union countries having on-arrival visa facility
- They are shown as part of a cultural troupe or tourists to reach a suitable destination from where they go to Mexico and enter the US by jumping over the wall

Cost: ₹50-80 lakh

THE EVER-AFTER PHASE



- The end of the long-drawn travel begins with the immigrant's detention by the Customs and Border Protection in the US



- In the odd instance, they go unnoticed. Then, they seek out an official and surrender. They are kept at a detention centre for about two months



- An immigration lawyer, supplied by the agent whose services could be included in the package, reaches out to the immigrant



- In court, they present their story, at times claiming threat to life in their country, and seek asylum



- The immigrant is released as a case under consideration with a GPS tracker



- Meanwhile, a job and a place to stay at an Indian family's home, restaurant or shop wait for them



- Families with children are viewed more favourably and given access to basic healthcare facilities and school education



- The asylum case can go on for a few months or a few years, while their life in America falls into gear



- Meanwhile, several gimmicks are adopted to make their case stronger, the most prominent being marriage to a citizen

THE GREAT EXPLOITATION

- Survivors and entrepreneurs in the US reveal that these immigrants are paid $10-12 (Rs 830-Rs 1,000) per hour or less. They work odd hours, straight through weekends and keep to their place of work for the fear of being apprehended
- Employers keep their passports, making them open-air prisoners

WHAT HAPPENS TO THE DEPORTEES

- Those deported en route to the US return to Gujarat
- The deportation cost, including air fare, is borne by their families
- They remain under close observation of the police, who seek to crack the local agents' illegal network
- They lie low for a while and, in most cases, attempt the *'dunki'* route again or finally give up